What is a producer?

BACKGROUND

consumers (say 'con-syoo-mers') – living things that eat or use food products made by producers or that eat other consumers

decomposers (say 'de-com-poz-ers') – living things that work to break down once-living materials into smaller parts

Producers are living things that make, or produce, their own food from inorganic (non-living) ingredients. Examples of producers are certain grass plants, vines and trees. Some of the inorganic ingredients that they use to make food include carbon dioxide and water.

Consumers and decomposers depend upon the food that producers make to provide them with energy.

☞ **1** Use full sentences to answer these questions about producers.

a) Are humans producers or consumers?

_____

b) Producers use what type of ingredients to produce their food?

_____

c) What does the word *produce* mean?

_____

d) What does the word *inorganic* mean?

_____

2 a) List four species of animals that rely on plants that produce fruit.

_____ _____

_____ _____

b) List four species of animals that need to eat grass in order to survive.

_____ _____

_____ _____

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What is a producer? CONT'D

3 Which of these foods that humans eat are produced by plants? Circle your answers.

wheat	cherries	watermelon
butter	corn	bacon
beans	milk	tomatoes
ice cream	eggs	onions
potatoes	jelly	bananas
apples	steak	carrots
grapes	sesame seeds	olives
chicken	oats	fish
rice	turkey	celery

4 Which producer plants do each of these foods and drinks come from?

a) sugar _____

b) peanut butter _____

c) coffee _____

d) tea _____

e) orange juice _____

f) soy milk _____

g) cornflakes _____

h) olive oil _____

i) wine _____

j) pasta _____

5 What do you think would happen if half of the producers in an ecosystem died out? How would this affect consumers? Give an example.

_____

_____

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